



Application Guide

Mozilla Technology Fund: AI and Environmental Justice

2024 Call for Proposals

We are living through a climate emergency. While we understand that the impacts of this crisis will not be evenly distributed, they will be felt by all.

[For the past two years](#), the Mozilla Technology Fund has funded research and development in the world of Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems; specifically, we have supported open source projects that have [increased transparency](#) and [mitigated bias](#) in the AI ecosystem. Increasingly, we are learning about the effects that the growing use of AI will have on ecosystems and the people who live in them. What steps might we take to reduce the environmental and climate impacts of AI adoption? And is there a role AI systems can play in addressing topics like environmental degradation, climate change, indigenous justice, food justice and energy justice? **This year, the Mozilla Technology Fund seeks to fund open source projects at the intersection of environmental justice and AI which are making a positive impact in ecosystems and human communities.**

Mozilla is interested in convening technical projects that have a firm grounding in environmental and climate justice, sustainability, and ecology. We understand that the effects of climate change will be felt disproportionately by the global south, especially people of color, indigenous and traditional peoples, local communities, and specific ethnic-racial groups. We are particularly interested in projects which can address the health, economic and social impacts of climate change on these groups (e.g. the Most Affected People and Areas (MAPA)) and which are built by these groups or in close partnership with affected communities.

The Mozilla Technology Fund will provide awards of up to \$50,000 each and one year of mentorship and support to open-source projects which meet the criteria listed below. Our goal is to provide projects in the MTF: AI and Environmental Justice cohort with the resources needed to unlock their full potential and to make them more sustainable in the long term.

About Mozilla

Mozilla exists to protect the internet as a global public resource, open and accessible to all. As a critical part of this mission, the [Mozilla Foundation](#) has increasingly focused on the transparency and accountability of artificial intelligence in consumer technology. Through [fellowships](#) and awards, we support innovative leaders in the realms of research, policy and technology for more trustworthy AI and a healthier internet



What are we looking for?

We imagine that the MTF: AI and Environmental Justice Awards will support a variety of hardware and software projects (including utilities and frameworks), datasets, tools, and design concepts. We will not consider applications for policy or research projects (though software projects which leverage, support, or amplify policy and research initiatives will be considered—for example, software which is built to support an ecological study that can be leveraged by other researchers). All applicants should:

- Have a product or working prototype in hand (we will also consider projects at the idea stage if the project team can demonstrate a track record of success in launching and building community around similar projects in the past)
- Already have a core team in place to support the development of the project (this team might include software developers working in close collaboration with ecologists, AI researchers, designers, product/project managers, and subject matter experts)
- Embrace openness, transparency, and community stewardship as methodology
- Make their work available under an open-source license

Who should apply?

These awards are open to all applicants regardless of geographic location or institutional affiliation, except where legally prohibited. However, Mozilla is *especially* interested in receiving applications from Most Affected People and Areas (MAPA); members of the Global Majority or Global South; Black, Indigenous, and other People of Color; women, transgender, non-binary, and/or gender-diverse applicants; migrant and diasporic communities; and/or persons coming from climate displaced/impacted communities, etc. **We strongly encourage all such applicants to apply.**

Eligibility Requirements

Applicants must meet the following requirements:

- Be legally able to receive funds in the form of a grant from the Mozilla Foundation (a U.S. 501(c)(3) non-profit organization)
- Be working towards solving a public interest problem or issue related to the focus of this Call for Proposals
- Meet the criteria outlined in the 'What are we looking for?' section above

FAQ's

Please consult our [Mozilla Awards FAQ](#) page. For questions not answered there, or for assistance using Fluxx to submit your application, please email grants@mozillafoundation.org



Application Process

Applications will be accepted for a period of four weeks and will then be reviewed by a committee of experts, which will make final funding decisions and allocate awards out of a total pool of \$300,000. Applicants can expect to hear back within six weeks of submitting an application; please email **MTF@mozillafoundation.org** with any questions. **Applications will be open from September 7th to October 5th, 2023** at 11:59pm Eastern Time.

Important Notes:

- All registrations and submissions must be in English. However, we encourage applicants to use free translation services. Applications will be reviewed based on their conceptual strength, not quality of language.
- No responsibility is assumed for lost, late, incomplete, invalid, illegible, incorrect, inaccurate, or misdirected registrations or submissions; or for any error, human, technical, or otherwise, that may occur in the processing of submissions.
- With applicant permission, submitted applications may be shared with other projects within Mozilla, other foundations, and partner organizations.
- Grantees are responsible to pay their own taxes on the grants. Mozilla reserves the right to withhold taxes as it believes necessary under applicable laws, and to reduce the net grant provided to the grantee accordingly.

Tips for Using Fluxx:

- To submit your application, visit <https://mozilla.fluxx.io/apply/mtf2023>.
- You must submit your application in Fluxx **before 5th October 2023 at 11:59 PM Eastern Time (3:59am UTC)**.
- Please review the application guidelines before submitting your application..
- Please note you cannot work on and save your application on this platform; you must complete and submit in one session.
- Required fields in the application are marked with an asterisk*.
- Fluxx uses a character count system. Spaces are considered characters. To avoid copy-and-paste issues, it may be easiest to type your answers directly into the Fluxx application.
- Only click the 'Submit' button when the page is complete. Once you submit, you will no longer be able to edit.
- Fluxx is not mobile-friendly. Plan to complete your application using a laptop or desktop computer.
- If you need to edit your contact info or need additional assistance using Fluxx, please reach out to: grants@mozillafoundation.org.



Fluxx Application Process

Complete LOI in Fluxx

The deadline to submit your LOI for the Mozilla Technology Fund is 5th October 2023 at 11:59 PM Eastern Time (3:59am UTC). Please review the application guidelines before submitting your application.

Submit LOI in Fluxx

To submit your LOI, visit <https://mozilla.fluxx.io/apply/mtf2023>. Please note you cannot work on and save your application on this platform; you must complete and submit in one session. Required fields are marked with an asterisk*.

LOI Application Questions

PROJECT DETAILS	
Proposed Project Title*	
Project Website	
Github or other code repository	
Amount Requested (up to USD 50,000)*	

Describe your open source project.*
What is it? What are your goals? Why do people use and/or contribute to your project?
(5000 characters or less)

Describe the purpose of your funding request. What are the key deliverables?*
This should be formatted as a bulleted list. If your request is successful, this list of



deliverables will be used to measure the success of your project.

(5000 characters or less)

What impact will the work detailed above have on the people who are connected to your project (e.g. users, contributors, community members and others)? How will you measure this impact?*

(5000 characters or less)

Describe your community.*

Who makes up the core team that maintains the project? Who contributes to it? Who uses and depends on your project? Are there ways in which your project is important to the larger open source ecosystem?

(5000 characters or less)

Will your project achieve any of the below aims?*

- Producing public interest research and writing
- Educating the public about a subject or issue
- Providing international aid
- Providing relief of poverty
- Producing or promoting artwork
- Advancing scientific research
- Combatting prejudice and discrimination
- Protecting the environment
- Protecting human rights secured by law
- None of the above

*Please explain your selection above.**

How do you plan to spend the requested funds?*

List key budget categories, the amount requested per category, and an explanation of how you calculated the total requested per category. If shortlisted and invited to submit a full application, you will be asked to submit a budget spreadsheet.



(5000 characters or less)

What license(s) does your project use?*

The MTF committee will only consider projects which are released publicly under a license that is either [a free software license according to the FSF](#) or [an open source license according to the OSI](#). Projects which are not licensed for use under an open source license are not eligible for funding.

(5000 characters or less)

Have you ever received a grant or award from Mozilla before?*

If yes, please tell us about it. How much were you awarded? What were your planned outcomes? Did you reach them? If not, why not?

(5000 characters or less)

[OPTIONAL] Was a translation tool/service used to complete this application?

We encourage the use of translation support to complete applications because we recognize that we are requiring applications to be completed in English and that English is not a primary language for many people. Applications are reviewed for conceptual strength, not quality of language, and we are asking this question to support reviewers to read the application according to how it was prepared.

(Select One) Yes/No

[OPTIONAL] DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

Mozilla is especially interested in receiving applications from members of the Global Majority or Global South; Black, Indigenous, and other People of Color; women, transgender and/or gender diverse applicants; migrant and diasporic communities; and/or persons coming from climate displaced/impacted communities, (e.g. Most Affected People and Areas). If you would like to share any demographic information with us you have the option to in the following text field.

Why are we collecting this information?



We are interested in understanding more about your social identity to ensure equitable access and prioritize opportunities for all applicants.

[OPTIONAL] Please share any demographic information with us here.

(250 characters or less)

APPLICANT DETAILS

These grants are open to all individuals, networks, and self-organized groups and organizations that are eligible to receive funding from Mozilla Foundation, a US-based 501(c)3 public charity, except where legally prohibited.

If your organization will be receiving the grant payment, please select the appropriate organization type and provide organizational contact information.

Applicant Type (select one)

☐	Individual
☐	Organization

Primary Contact / Applicant Details

Prefix	
First Name	
Last Name	
Title	
Affiliated Organization (if applying as individual)	
Email	
Work Phone	

**Organization Information (if applying as an organization)****Organization's Legal Name**

Popular name used by organization (if different from legal name)

Organization Tax Details (if applying as an organization)**Country of Incorporation****Tax Status (select from options below)**

	Nonprofit organization/NGO		
		If NGO, select from options below:	
		US 501(c)3 public charity	
		US 501(c)3 private foundation	
		Non-US nonprofit/NGO with public charity equivalency determination	
		Non-US nonprofit/NGO without equivalency determination	
			If Non-US, answer the following:
			What is your organization's legally registered status in your country (i.e. non-governmental organization, public benefit organization, companies limited by guarantee, charitable trusts, societies, etc.)?
			Does your organization have shareholders of any kind?
	Organization applying using fiscal sponsorship agreement		
		If fiscal sponsorship, answer the following regarding the fiscal sponsor:	
		Legal Name of Fiscal Sponsor	
		Fiscal Sponsor's Tax Status (see above if fiscal sponsor is NGO)	
	For-profit organization		
	Governmental unit		



	Other (please describe)
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Organization Address (if applying as an organization)**Address 1**

Address 2

City**Country**

State/Province

Postal Code (Zip)**Organization Contact Details (if applying as an organization)**

Organization Phone

Main Organization E-Mail

Website

Social Account(s)

Is the head of your organization also the primary contact listed above? Yes/No.

If No: Who is the head of your organization?

Prefix

First Name**Last Name****Title (e.g. Executive Director)****Email**

Phone

**Personal Links (if applying as an individual)**

Personal website

LinkedIn

Social Account(s)

Github or other code repository

Personal Address (if applying as an individual)

Address 1

Address 2

City

Country

State/Province

Postal Code (Zip)

Submission Terms*

I agree to the [Mozilla Privacy Policy](#).

Once you click '**Submit Request**,' you should see a confirmation that your registration request has been received.

You will also receive a confirmation email, which will be delivered from domain [fluxx.io](#).
Please update your spam filters accordingly.